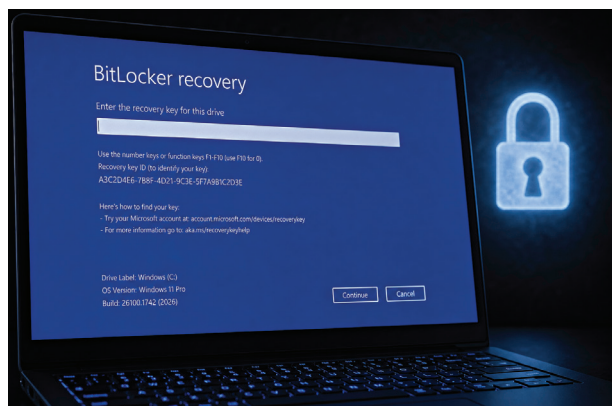


Android Private Space for applications that should not sit openly beside everyday ones. Private Space can hide its applications from the launcher, recent views and several system surfaces while locked, and can use a separate lock. It is useful for local separation, not magical anonymity; the device owner, operating system, network and service providers may still retain links.

The 20-minute Windows privacy audit

Begin with Settings > Windows Update and install supported security and application updates. If the computer remains on Windows 10 without a paid or organisational extension arrangement, migrate to a supported operating system rather than treating antivirus software as a substitute for security fixes.

Next, open Settings > Privacy & security > Device encryption, or search for BitLocker. Confirm that encryption is on for the operating-system drive and any fixed drives containing sensitive material. Locate the recovery key and store it separately; do not discover during a motherboard failure that the only key was saved on the encrypted computer.



Open Settings > Accounts > Sign-in options and configure Windows Hello with a PIN, fingerprint or compatible facial-recognition camera. The Windows Hello PIN is associated with that device rather than functioning as a reusable online password. Also create separate Windows accounts for different people; sharing one login exposes browser sessions, files, notifications and saved credentials.

Now visit Settings > Privacy & security and review Location, Camera, Microphone, Contacts, Calendar, Messaging and other categories. Windows allows per-capability controls, but Microsoft warns that traditional desktop applications may not appear in the same lists and can access some data differently. Treat installed desktop software as a separate trust decision.

Continue with these checks:

1. Under System > Notifications, disable lock-screen content for messaging, mail, banking and work applications.
2. Under Apps > Installed apps, remove software you no longer use.
3. Review which supported applications can run in the background and set unnecessary ones to Never.
4. Keep User Account Control enabled so administrator-level changes require approval.
5. Open Windows Security and resolve warnings under virus protection, firewall, device security and account protection.
6. Review Phone Link; notification syncing can copy phone alerts onto the PC, widening the number of screens on which private information appears.

Finally, inspect OneDrive and other synchronisation tools. Decide which folders should leave the computer, whether screenshots and desktop files are uploading automatically and whether shared links remain active. Encryption on the laptop protects the local drive; it does not determine who can access a cloud copy.

iPhone, macOS and Linux essentials

On an iPhone, review Settings > Privacy & Security to control access to location, contacts, photographs, Bluetooth, microphone, camera and other data. Turn on App Privacy Report to see how applications use granted permissions and view their network activity. Safety Check can rapidly review sharing, connected devices and account security when a person faces abuse or unwanted access.

On a Mac, use System Settings > Privacy & Security to inspect the same broad categories, enable FileVault where appropriate, review login items and remove unfamiliar configuration profiles. On Ubuntu or another Linux distribution, install security updates promptly, use full-disk encryption, avoid routinely operating as an administrator and install software from trusted repositories. Ubuntu documents full-disk encryption, unattended security upgrades and AppArmor-based privilege restriction as core protections.

Action lab: Perform the device exposure test

Lock the device and place it on a table. Without unlocking it, note everything a stranger can learn: your name, messages, caller identities, appointments, delivery updates, connected earbuds and emergency information. Remove anything unnecessarily exposed.

Unlock it and imagine one ordinary application has been compromised. Check what its current permissions would reveal. Then imagine the device is stolen while powered off. Confirm that storage encryption, remote-location tools and account recovery are ready.

Repeat the test every three months. Device hardening is not a one-time ceremony because applications, accounts, updates and permissions change. The best privacy setup is one you understand, maintain and can recover without surrendering control of the device carrying your life. 